

# Observing Proposal PHYS 782 F26

October 1, 2026

## 1 Observing Proposal

### 1.1 Outline

1. Pick a scientific topic (different from your thesis, but can be related) that can be addressed with optical or near IR imaging or spectroscopy in semester 27A or 27B.
2. Apply either for a
  - CFHT [instrument](#)
    - Megacam - Imaging
    - WIRCAM - Imaging
    - SITELLE - FTS
    - Espadons - high resolution echelle spectrograph
    - SPIROU - Near infrared spectropolarimetry
  - or a
  - Gemini [Facility Instrument](#) (Not Visiting):
    - Too many to list
    - Most popular are GMOS-N and GMOS-S, which has optical/NIR Imaging, multi-object spectroscopy, and IFU
3. Application process:
  - CFHT: copy the LaTeX example (and style file) in the CFHT folder under Examples and Templates folder on Teams and re-write
  - Gemini: download and use the latest PIT tool in conjunction with the LaTeX or Word templates. **Do not** click “Submit”. Instead, from the File Menu, choose “Export PDF” and submit on LEARN

On the application PDF use the code name given to you.

### 1.2 Advice

Important components of a proposal

1. What is the main scientific question and why is it important?
2. OK, if it's so important, why hasn't it been solved already? What problems are there with previous approaches?
3. What are you planning to do that is substantially different from what has been done before?

4. Is your observing plan *technically* feasible: can you achieve the right sample size and signal-to-noise in a reasonable amount of telescope time? (In this case reasonable means *usually* ~2-~14 nights on CFHT or ~10-100 hours on Gemini. However, your proposal could be the first installment of a larger program).

Also for general advice you can read \* [How to write a \(potentially successful\) observing proposal](#)

- [How to write a proposal](#)

### 1.3 Timeline

- Abstract: Monday October 26, 11 PM
- Proposal Submission: Monday Dec 14, 9 PM
- Referee reports: Thursday Dec 18, 9 PM
- “TAC” Meeting: Monday Dec 21, 1 - 6 PM in PHYS 308 (to be confirmed)

### 1.4 Evaluation

You will be evaluated on

1. Abstract
2. **Full proposal**
3. Submitted referee report. The referee reports will be shared in Teams.
4. The discussion/feedback you provide at the TAC regarding your evaluation/grades of the other proposals.